



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Atlanta
School Website: <https://chestertonatl.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Atlanta (CAATL) presents as a clearly Catholic, classical high school rooted in a robust theology-driven mission and a public-facing classical curriculum. Across public materials, the school foregrounds Catholic faith, liturgical life, and virtue formation, while articulating a traditional liberal-arts orientation (including Latin, philosophy, theology, and the humanities) and a pedagogy that emphasizes a three-pillared framework: Intellect, Character, and Spirituality. Several elements align strongly with classical education norms—theological formation, integration of liberal arts, and a high value placed on virtue and formation. Some pedagogical specifics (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, or detailed Great Books/Great Conversation commitments) are less explicit in public content, which introduces a modest degree of interpretive uncertainty about the exact pedagogy. Overall, CAATL lands as CLASSICAL, with room to further crystalize certain pedagogical practices to reach full general alignment.

Key drivers of classification: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Clear, ongoing Catholic formation (Mass daily, theology, Catechism), oath-related fidelity to Magisterium, liturgical life, sacral art, and chaplain presence. This strongly supports a Classical, religiously grounded foundation. Evidence: daily Mass, theology instruction, Catechism, Magisterium fidelity, liturgical life.

- School Purpose and Goal: Mission foregrounds formation, virtue, and a classical/catholic telos aimed at leadership, saints, and competent, holistic human excellence, not solely job preparation. Evidence: "joyful leaders and saints," classical tradition, truths of Catholic faith, formation toward college and life. - Curriculum: Strong liberal-arts orientation is evident (classics of Western thought, Latin requirement, integrated humanities emphasis). Evidence: "classics of Western thought," Latin requirement, reference to curriculum overview, and the three-pillars framing of intellect.

- Pedagogy: Public materials emphasize a contemplative/remembered-seed approach (e.g., singing/memory in lower grades; high-school emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking appears in arts/culture framing) but explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not consistently stated in public pages. This yields a "Somewhat Classical" signal on pedagogy, pending more explicit explicit Seminars/Socratic structures in public materials. Evidence: lower-school singing and memory, emphasis on rhetoric and speeches in arts program; absence of explicit, consistent Socratic/seminar language in public pages. - Faculty: Public materials describe qualified, devout faculty and leadership, with a visible governance/board structure, and the Headmaster's credentials align with classical education lineage. This supports a classical faculty profile. Evidence: Headmaster credentials, board presence, faith-forming commitments.

- Parents & Community: The school emphasizes parent engagement and transparency (open houses, shadow days, parent-facing sessions, accessible visits), indicating a classical partnership with families. Evidence: Admissions information, open houses, shadow days, parent sessions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Daily Mass begins the school day; theology taught from Bible and Catechism; papal documents referenced; sacral art and crucifixes present; regular adoration and retreats; chaplains or religious visits; Oath of Fidelity to Magisterium. - Quick Facts framing the mission as Catholic and the school as a classical,

Catholic institution; emphasis on the magisterium and sacred formation. - Our History describes a Catholic identity anchored in St. Catherine of Siena parish and canonical alignment within the Archdiocese.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholicism, Mass, Theology, Catechism, Magisterium, Oath of Fidelity, Adoration, Pilgrimages, Retreats, Sacred art, Crucifixes, Chaplains, Liturgical life. - Negative keywords present: None detected in public materials.

Why this rating - The school publicly foregrounds a sacramental, doctrinal, liturgical, and ecclesial axis in daily life and academics, which is the strongest possible signal of a Classical Catholic foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes formation toward virtue and leadership within a Catholic framework, “joyful leaders and saints,” and formation in the classical tradition and Catholic truth. - Emphasis on the true, good, and beautiful in a classical frame (implicitly via “truths of the Catholic faith” and formation toward human excellence). - The program aims to prepare for college, professional life, and service to family, country, and Christ, indicating formation over narrow job-readiness emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal education, classical tradition, Catholic faith, leadership, service, telos/human excellence. - Negative keywords present: Not detected in public materials (no explicit emphasis on purely job-readiness or secular usefulness).

Why this rating - CAATL foregrounds formation, virtue, and knowledge rooted in truth and goodness, aligning with classical teleology rather than mere information or workforce preparation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a liberal-arts orientation with Western thought, and a curriculum framed by the three pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality). - Latin requirement for three years, with multiple tracks in math (Foundations, Traditional, C-STEM) and science progression, indicating a rigorous, integrated liberal-arts approach rather than a purely vocational focus. - The curriculum emphasizes classics, philosophy, theology, and the humanities (the three pillars explicitly tie intellect to classical study). - A Curriculum Overview PDF is referenced, signaling formal, content-rich curriculum design.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation (implied by the classical framework), Latin, Western thought, theology, philosophy, integrated humanities, history-culture linkage, wonder, and the liberal-arts tradition. - Negative keywords present: None clearly present in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present a liberal-arts curriculum with classical elements (grammar/logics/rhetoric framing, Latin, Western thought, integrated humanities, and a focus on formation rather than mere information), supporting CLASSICAL status.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Three Pillars framework signals a holistic approach to intellect, character, and spirituality, with emphasis on a cohesive, content-rich education. This aligns with classical aims but public materials are less explicit about traditional pedagogical markers (Socratic seminars, recitation, etc.). - Lower-school pedagogy evidence includes singing, memory, and a focus on wonder and restrained, contemplative elements; upper-school mentions of rhetoric and oratory are present in arts and public-speaking emphasis, but explicit Socratic seminars are not consistently documented in public materials. - The presence of a house system and classical cultural practices (Oxford/Cambridge reference) hints at aristocratic, tradition-based pedagogy rather than fully modern, constructivist approaches.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative/scholé, wonder, memory/recitation, rhetoric, oratory, debate, speeches, classical pedagogy, living curriculum (conceptually im-

plied), sacred/liturgical integration in instruction. - Negative keywords present: Explicit project-based learning, purely experiential learning, or secular/constructivist pedagogy are not documented in public materials; absence is notable rather than presence.

Why this rating - CAATL demonstrates a strong classical orientation through formation-centric aims and a broad classical curriculum, but explicit articulation and consistent public-facing evidence of classical pedagogical forms (e.g., Socratic seminars across grades) are not always explicit. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating, with room to explicitly codify and publish the full pedagogical playbook (e.g., explicit Socratic and recitation practices and detailed Scholé days) to achieve full CLASSICAL status.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Headmaster and faculty leadership hold substantial classical and Catholic credentials (e.g., Headmaster's degrees in History, Philosophy, and humanities; prior teaching at a classical academy). - Governance structure includes a Board of Directors, with the school explicitly operating under the authority of the Board and with canonical alignment (Archdiocese process). - Accreditation efforts and canonical designation as an independent Catholic school reflect a disciplined, formal faculty governance and professional standards.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum (conceptual), collegial practice, board of directors, headmaster, fidelity to Magisterium, Catholic identity, certification/accreditation. - Negative keywords present: None clearly indicated in public materials.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a strong, formation-focused faculty profile with visible leadership, a formal governance structure, and alignment with Catholic identity and classical aims. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Admissions materials emphasize parent-facing opportunities (open houses, shadow days, informational sessions) and family involvement in the enrollment process, signaling partnership with families as co-educators. - The Quick Facts and Our History emphasize community-building, parental involvement, and ongoing engagement with the Chesterton Schools Network and local parish life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, parent sessions, family involvement, shared mission, classical home culture (as implied by the network's ethos). - Negative keywords present: None detected in public materials.

Why this rating - CAATL presents a strong, explicit posture of parent engagement and a culture of community involvement typical of classical education.

Aggregate assessment - Category classifications: CLASSICAL (Cat 1), CLASSICAL (Cat 2), CLASSICAL (Cat 3), SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Cat 4), CLASSICAL (Cat 5), CLASSICAL (Cat 6). - Overall, CAATL is CLASSICAL, with Element 4 representing a possible refinement area to achieve full CLASSICAL status across pedagogy.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly codify and publish explicit Socratic/seminal pedagogy practices (e.g., a clear framework for Socratic seminars, the use of classical dialectic in upper grades, and structured memory work and recitation) to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Increase explicit mention of Great Books/Great Conversation and direct articulation of interdisciplinary integration across subjects in public-facing materials, including concrete examples (syllabi, sample "Great Conversation" readings).
- Curriculum (Element 3): Publish a more explicit list of canonical works and primary sources (Great Books) across grades, including the integration of primary texts in history, philosophy, theology, and literature, to reinforce the Great Books/Great Conversation identity.

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- Public Materials (Cross-cutting): Expand language about “Scholé” days, contemplative rest, and rest/recitation-based pedagogy in the public-facing narrative to provide clearer alignment with classical pedagogy norms.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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